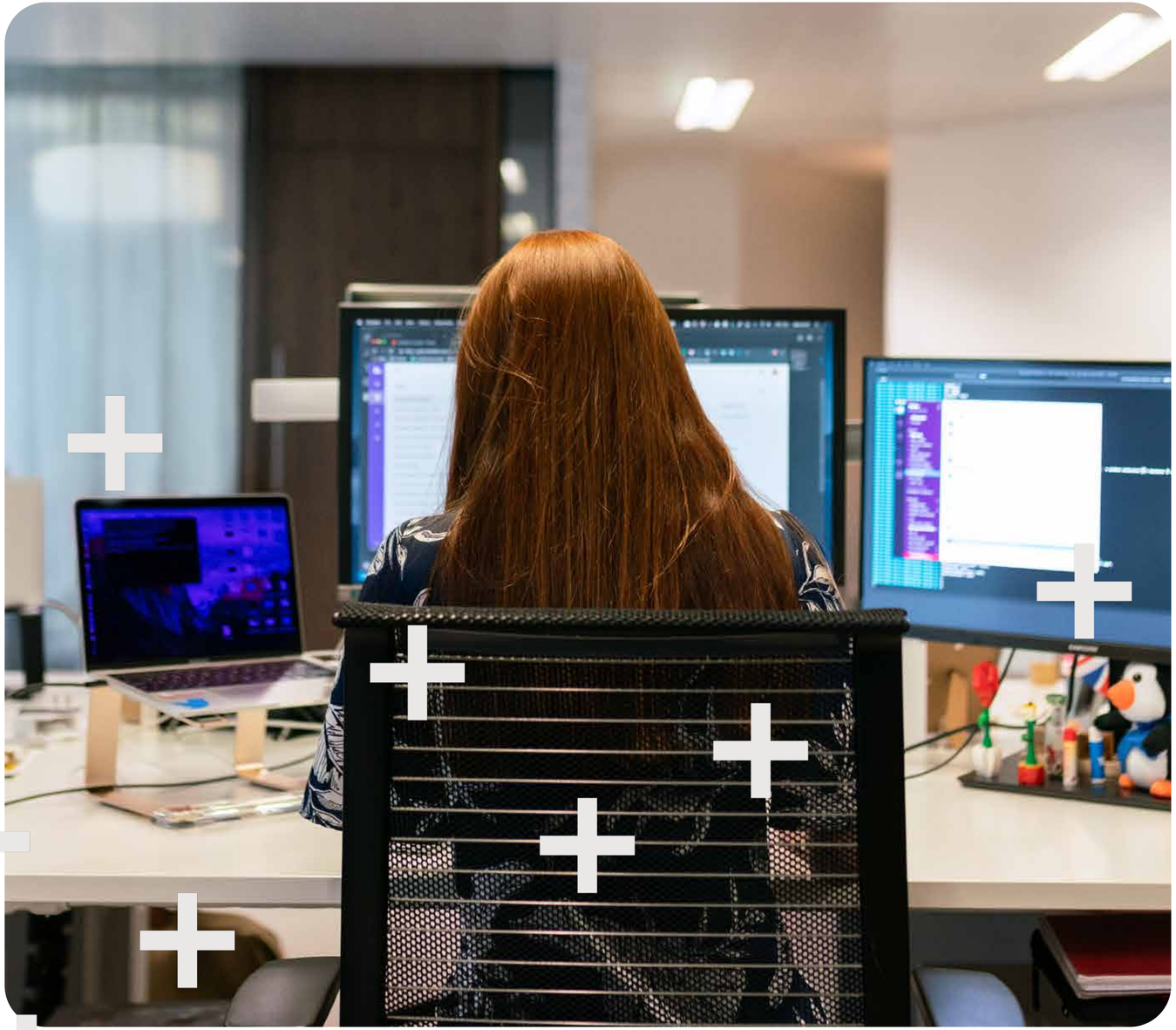
Brand Guidelines

VECTOR INSTITUTE

2026

Table of Contents



This guide has been developed to inform the consistent usage of the Vector Institute brandmark & related visual elements for print & digital applications. By following the simple rules in this guide, you will help to establish & sustain a clear, consistent, positive brand identity for Vector's people, partners, & stakeholders. This is a living, breathing document.

As we continue to evolve, this guide will be updated. We appreciate your feedback & input. If you have any questions about the use of this guide, or suggestions for improvement, please email marcomm@vectorinstitute.ai

OVERVIEW 03
VALUES 04
BRAND BELIEF 05
BRAND NARRATIVE 06
CREATIVE PLATFORM 07
VOICE & TONE 08
KEY MESSAGING 09
LOGO 10
COLOUR 18
TYPOGRAPHY 20
ILLUSTRATIONS 23
BACKGROUNDS 25
PHOTOGRAPHY 27
VISUAL RULES 31
BRAND APPLICATION 37

Overview

Our brand is a key element of our mandate

By establishing partnerships, nationally and internationally across all sectors and industries, Vector catalyzes system-level change through responsibly applied AI. We do this to build and attract economic opportunities so that governments, organizations and citizens have confidence that Canada is present in the creation of our global future – **and our brand is a direct extension and expression of this**. Our brand voice is the champion, the convener, the voice of a collective – fostering a world-class community of researchers building AI, enabling organizations applying AI and amplifying voices of Canadians who are benefiting from AI.

It serves as a critical component of our strategy and aspiration. We use our brand and communications to create a deeper understanding of our offerings and key insights/issues we believe our ecosystem is focused on.

At Vector: Among our own community, our brand is arguably the key component of why people work for and with Vector – as it helps us build not only awareness, but pride for how we serve our stakeholders (government, businesses, academia, job seekers, health partners). Externally: Amongst our varying audiences and existing/prospective sponsors, our brand serves as a true differentiator, helping us articulate a bold vision for AI and Canada's leadership within the global ecosystem, enabling enhanced consideration in the market.

Marketing is accountable for the brand and positioning but **all staff and researchers are responsible for leveraging brand guidelines** to help us articulate the brand with respective networks.



VECTOR INSTITUTE

Brand Values

Vision

The Vector Institute drives excellence and leadership in Canada's knowledge, creation, and use of artificial intelligence (AI) to foster economic growth and improve the lives of Canadians.

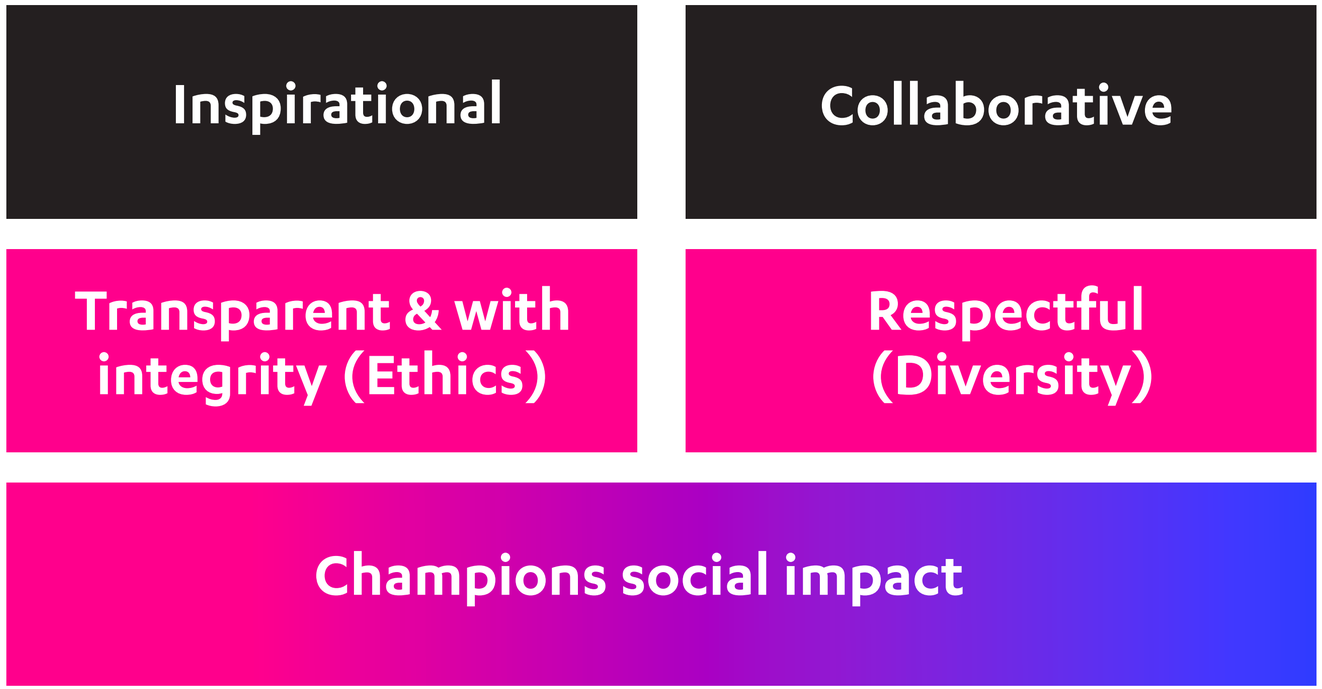
Artificial Intelligence is not what Vector Institute does – it's why we exist.

Mission

- **Lead efforts to build and sustain AI-based innovation, growth and productivity** in Canada by focusing on deep learning and machine learning.
- Together with our AI partners, **work with industry and public institutions to ensure that they have the people, skills, and resources to be best in class** at the use of AI.
- **Support Canada's innovation clusters in AI** and focus on helping startups grow to become Canadian-based global leaders.
- **Attract the best global talent, focused on research excellence.** Our researchers and academic partners will be part of a vibrant community of innovation problem-solvers, working across disciplines on both curiosity-driven and applied research.

Vector's Values

Vector's brand is a champion of Canadian-informed AI and should be seen as:



VECTOR INSTITUTE

Our Brand Belief

We believe AI powers possibility

We lead cutting-edge research and bring it to life through real-world application.

We collaborate with research, industry and government partners to turn breakthroughs into progress and outcomes.

Brand Narrative

Welcome to life on the precipice. A time of great potential, possibility, and opportunity.

New leadership, both in Canada and abroad, is challenging what's possible. As generational powers shift, fresh ways of thinking and doing are bursting forward with new voices looking to challenge what's-been-done, to create a brighter what-could-be.

Yet as we stand on this precipice of possibility, there's a lack of movement at home. More than AI ambition, we need AI action. Because the longer we wait, the sooner we'll be left behind.

At the Vector Institute, we believe AI powers possibility, but possibilities alone aren't enough. That's why we propel cutting-edge AI research and bring it to life through real-world applications that benefit the economy, each other, and the planet at large.

Collaborating with research, industry, and government partners, we ensure breakthroughs lead to tangible progress and outcomes through incubating the world's best talent, bridging sectors, and building trust.

A proud non-profit community featuring over 900 members, we attract the world's most accomplished and innovative researchers, and advance breakthroughs in the science and commercialization of AI and machine learning.

We've given out millions in scholarships, raised billions in funding, & empowered hundreds of businesses to adopt with confidence. Driven by intellect, guided by integrity, and committed to shaping a better future, we don't just want to be part of innovation, we want to be part of innovation we can stand behind.

Vector is where world class AI meets the world it's meant to serve, where possibility meets productivity, & where AI ambition meets AI action.



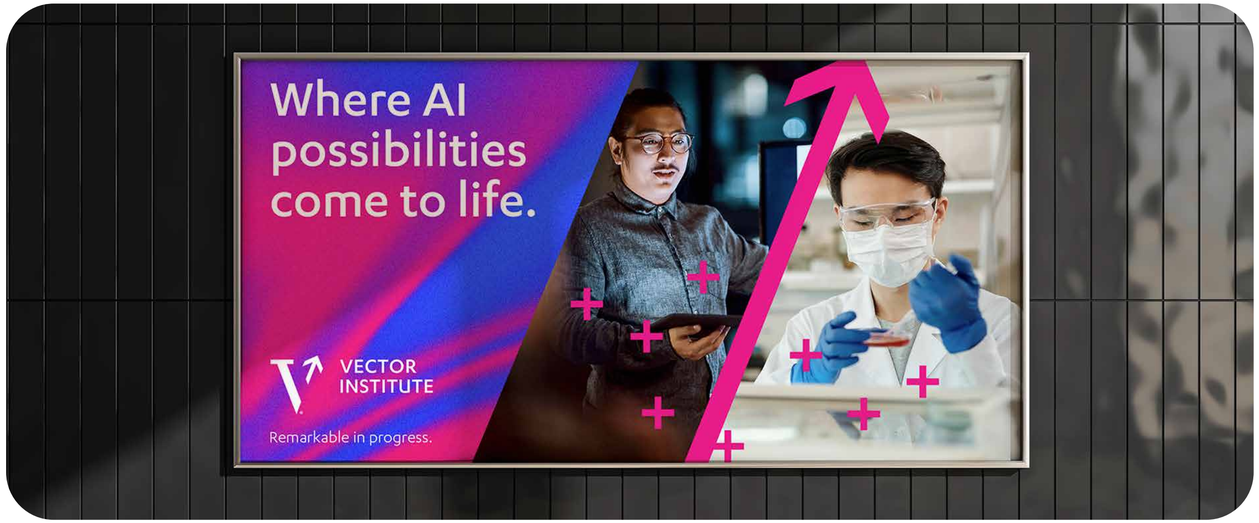
Creative Platform

Remarkable in progress

Separating ourselves from the common convenor, Remarkable in Progress embodies how we relentlessly and responsively push AI and machine learning forward through research, commercialization & adoption.

The AI ecosystem we've created is forever in motion, so our internal & external messaging should reflect that endless evolution.





Voice & Tone

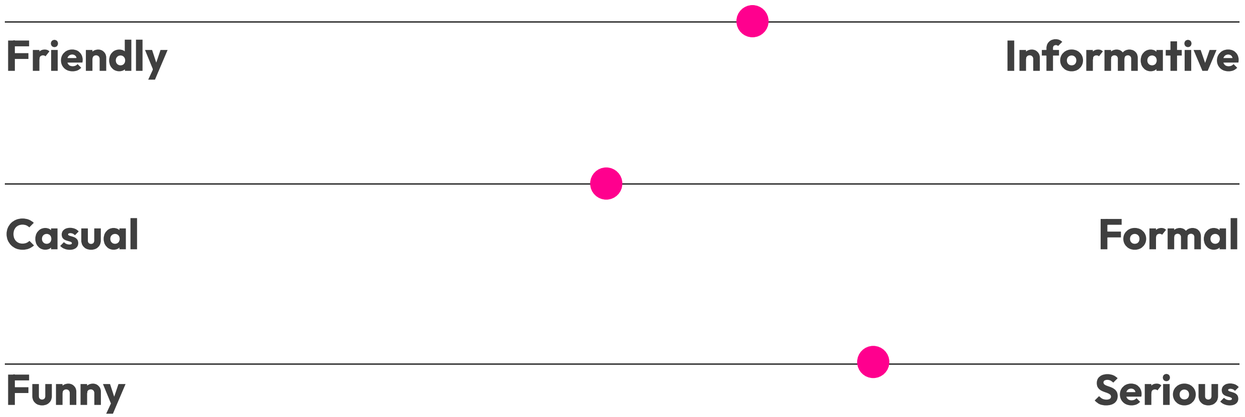
Communication, Style, Tone and Voice

Our research institute speaks from a place of expertise, driven by the inquisitive nature of our researchers. The way we communicate is deeply rooted in the academic freedom and collaborative spirit that characterize our environment and diverse community. Our tone is informed and polished, a testament to the smart and innovative work we do, yet it remains accessible and inclusive—not overly formal or distant. We value being clear and direct, ensuring that the knowledge we share reflects the thoughtful and confident findings of our community. While our work is serious and cutting-edge, we maintain a level of approachability in our communications, being professional without being overly rigid. Our language is a mirror of our mission: to advance knowledge in a way that is as approachable as it is impressive.

For additional communications guidance please review our **Communications Style Guide.**

Brand Personality

· Contemporary
· Leading edge
· Innovative / Creative
· Smart / Bright / Confident
· Remarkable



VECTOR INSTITUTE

Key Messaging

This section consists of a range of language customized to 4 key external audiences. We also have headlines that can speak to all audiences at once.

All Audiences

Headlines:

Where AI possibilities come to life.
Where AI ambition meets AI action.

These key messages are meant to be an ever-evolving entity, shifting with new organizational priorities, fresh data points, and things of the like.

Industry Partners

Headlines:

Ensuring AI breakthroughs generate commercial outcomes.

Ecosystem Partners

Headlines:

Where AI possibility meets productivity.

Public sector allies

Headlines:

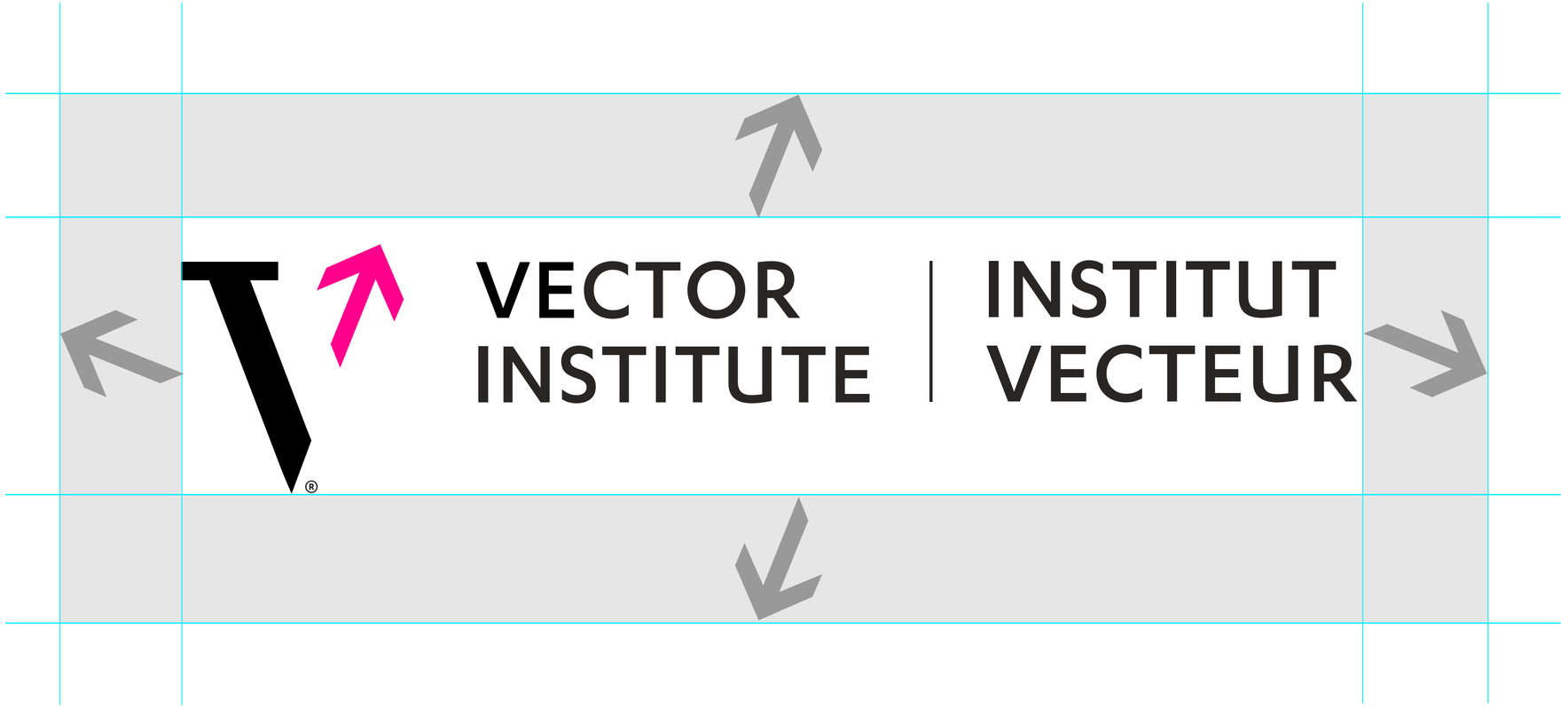
AI research you can trust, applied AI partners you can depend on.
Propelling research that benefits the economy, each other, and the planet.

Research Communities

Headlines:

Where your research could become real-world applications.
Where world class AI research meets the world it’s meant to serve.

Logo - Whitespace



Our foundational brandmark identifies us by name, tells people what we're about, and establishes our visual identity; therefore, it's important that it's consistent. It is composed of two main elements, a logo and a name.

1. The logo — a stylized 'V' made up of the letter (for Vector) incorporating a detached arrow is the mathematical symbol for a vector. This image also conveys forward and upward movement, future possibilities and innovation.

2. Our legal name, "Vector Institute," in English and "Institut Vecteur" in French.

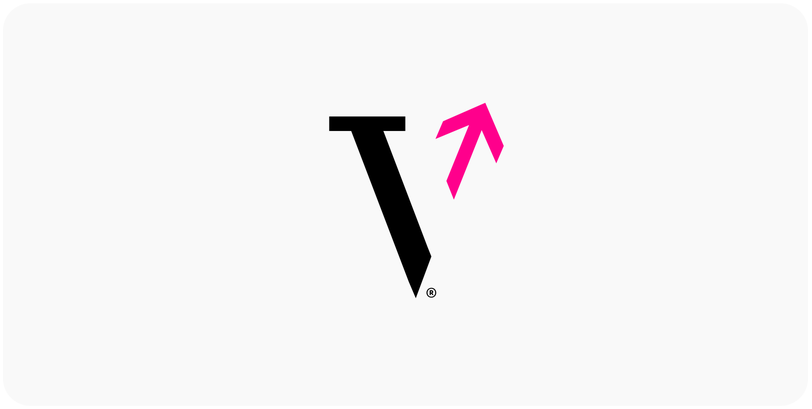
To maximize our presence and visual identity, a specified clear space defines and protects the area around the brandmark to avoid crowding or confusion.

There must be a minimum margin of clear space around the Vector logo. The minimum clear space is equal to the height of the arrow.

Logo / Variants



LOGO LOCKUP - HORIZONTAL DEFAULT



LOGO - ICON

Depending on the application, the vertical and horizontal brandmarks are available in full colour (black and magenta, or white and magenta), black, and white. Use your best judgement when selecting between horizontal and vertical options.

Our logo icon is the shorter version of our logo. Use the icon only on its own if you do not have enough space for the full logo. While the logo icon can exist without the wordmark, the wordmark cannot exist without the logo icon.



LOGO LOCKUP - HORIZONTAL - REVERSE



LOGO LOCKUP - HORIZONTAL - KNOCKOUT

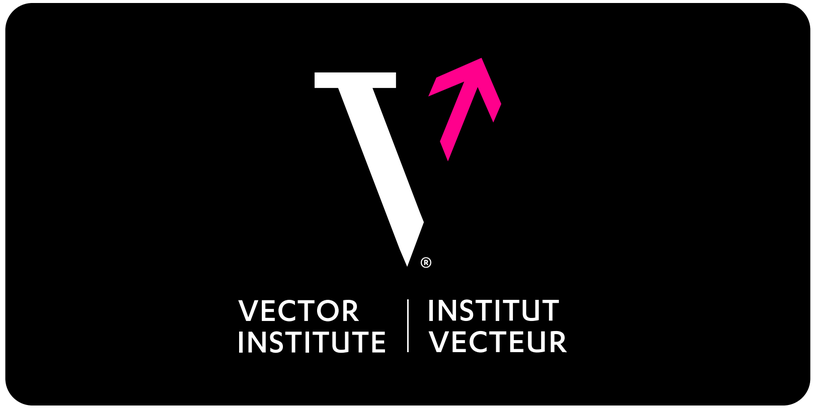
Logo / Variants



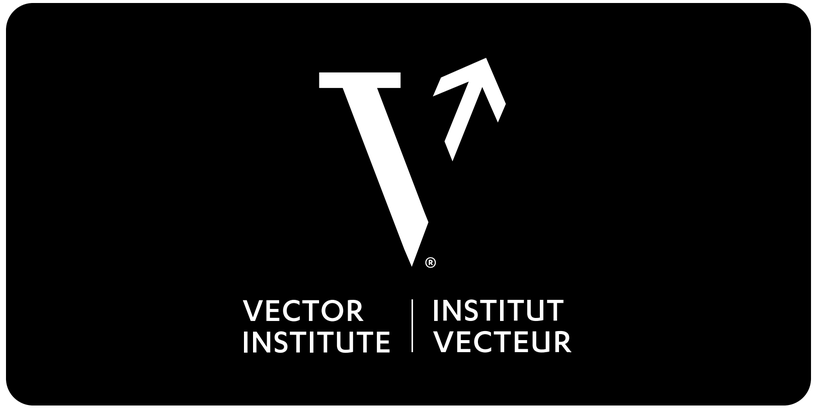
LOGO LOCKUP - ENGLISH VERTICAL



LOGO LOCKUP - BILINGUAL VERTICAL DEFAULT



LOGO LOCKUP - BILINGUAL VERTICAL REVERSE



LOGO LOCKUP - BILINGUAL VERTICAL KNOCKOUT

At Vector, it is our policy to offer official written communications to the public in both English and French to accommodate all stakeholders and partners. This is to not only comply with the Contributions Agreement of the National Artificial Intelligence Institutes but also to continuously seek new ways to promote linguistic duality and inclusivity in all aspects of the institute's operations. This means that in a lot of instances, Vector's bilingual logo should be used most often versus the English only logo on digital properties and for whitepapers, annual reports, on nationally targeted social media promotions etc.

External facing communications must always use the bilingual logo.

Logo / Variants



BILINGUAL LOGO LOCKUP - HORIZONTAL DEFAULT

At Vector, it is our policy to offer official written communications to the public in both English and French to accommodate all stakeholders and partners. This is to not only comply with the Contributions Agreement of the National Artificial Intelligence Institutes but also to continuously seek new ways to promote linguistic duality and inclusivity in all aspects of the institute's operations. This means that in a lot of instances, Vector's bilingual logo should be used most often versus the English only logo on digital properties and for whitepapers, annual reports, on nationally targeted social media promotions etc.

External facing communications must always use the bilingual logo.



BILINGUAL LOGO LOCKUP - HORIZONTAL - REVERSE



BILINGUAL LOGO LOCKUP - HORIZONTAL - KNOCKOUT

Logo / Variants - Fastlane

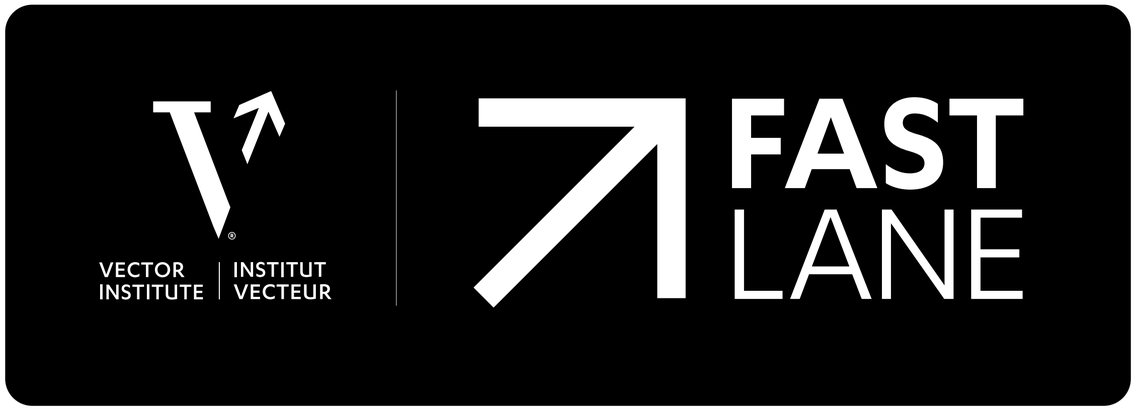


FASTLANE LOGO LOCKUP - HORIZONTAL DEFAULT

Our Fastlane logo shown in various formats. The Fastlane logo is always used in conjunction with the Vector logo.



FASTLANE LOGO LOCKUP - HORIZONTAL - REVERSE



FASTLANE LOGO LOCKUP - HORIZONTAL - KNOCKOUT

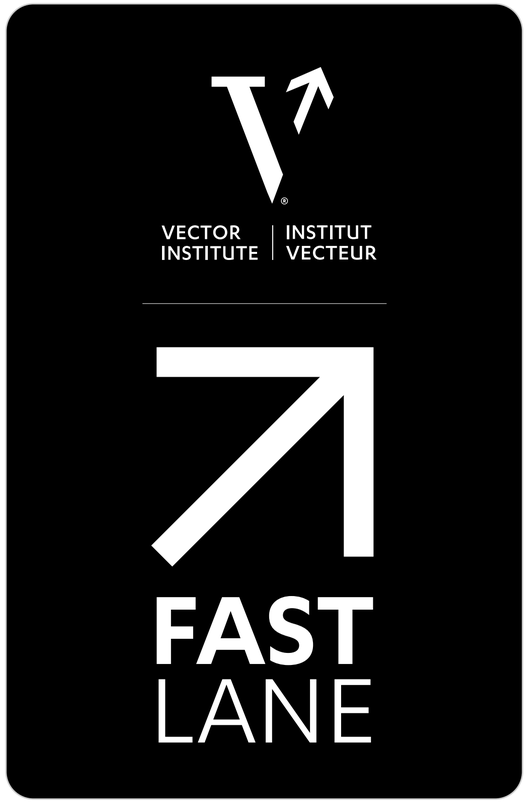
Logo / Variants



FASTLANE LOGO LOCKUP - VERTICAL DEFAULT



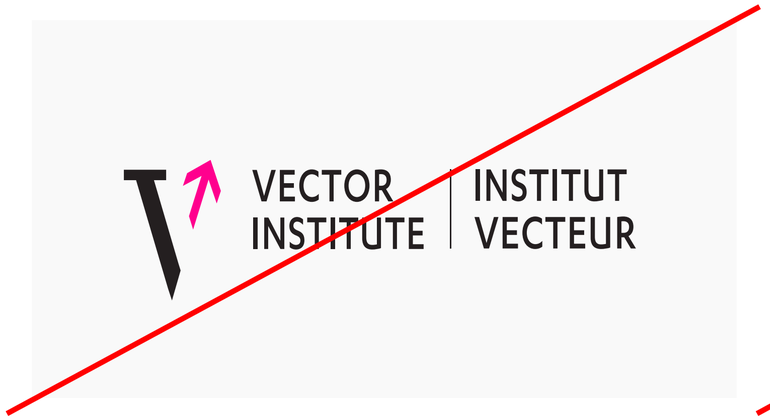
LOGO LOCKUP - VERTICAL - REVERSE

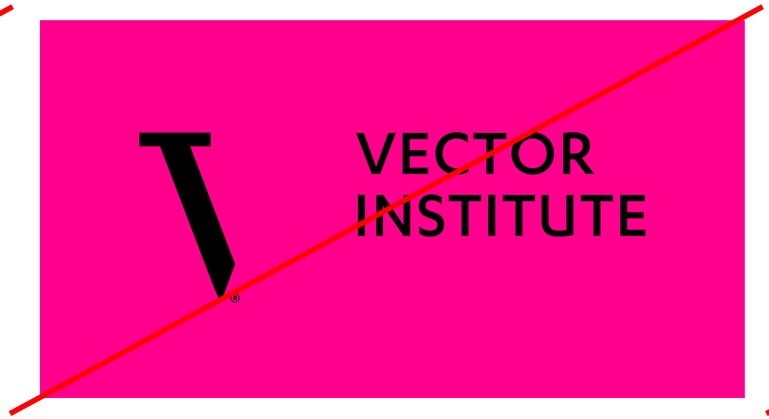


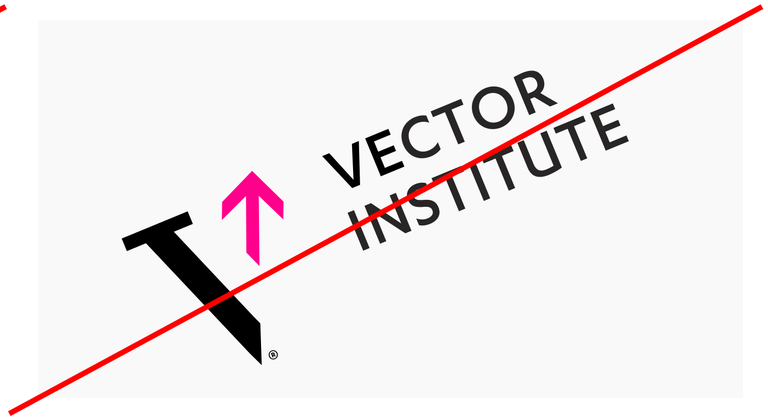
FASRLANE LOGO LOCKUP - KNOCKOUT

VECTOR INSTITUTE

Logo Misuse


VECTOR
INSTITUTE
INSTITUT
VECTEUR


VECTOR
INSTITUTE


VECTOR
INSTITUTE


VECTOR
INSTITUTE


VECTOR
INSTITUTE


VECTOR
INSTITUTE

Partner Logos

Co-branding logos & Acknowledgements

Logo placements for co-branding

When the Vector Institute brandmark needs to sit side by side with our logos, it is important to consider size, placement and relevance.

- Our preference is for our signature to appear to the left.
- Our brandmark needs clear space around it to “breathe”. Please follow the Clear Space & Minimium Size guidelines on page 9.
- The Vector brandmark and other logo should be the same height.







Acknowledgements

As per our agreement with the Province of Ontario, advertising and promotional materials must acknowledge and credit Ontario government financial support by using the wording “Funding provided by the Government of Ontario” and by using the official visual identity of the Province of Ontario. Additional requirements may be stipulated for federal government and other funding.

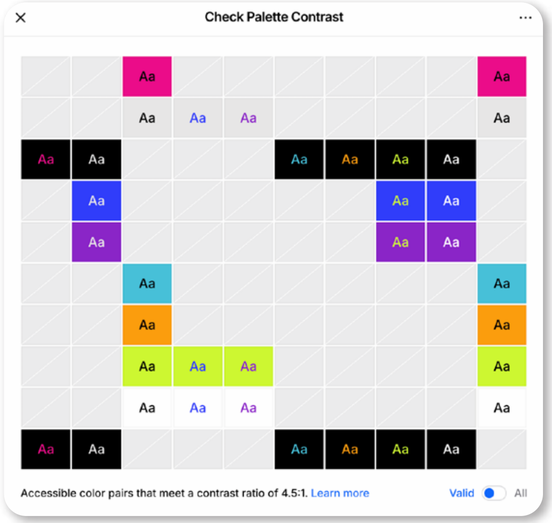
Colour

Colour palette usage

Consistent adherene to the colour guidelines will help build visibility and recognition of our brand.

Primary Palette:
These colours are to be used in most of our priority brand-level communications, from stationery and reports, to marketing and communications materials when NOT related to a specific sector i.e. Health, Industry, Government or Academic Institutions.

Secondary Palette:
These colours can be used for accents and highlights to accompany primary colours as long as branding remains sophisticated and professional. They are also assigned to colour-code our specific segments: Broader Public Sector **#313CFF**, Industry **#8A25C9**, and Academic Institutions **#48C0D9**.



Refer to this contrast checker to verify that colour combinations meet accessibility standards.

The chart indicates which pairings achieve the required contrast ratios for compliant use.

PRIMARY

Magenta
#EB088A
RGB: 235, 8, 138
CMYK: 0, 100, 0, 0
Pantone: Process Magenta C

Grey
#E9E8E8
RGB: 233, 232, 232
CMYK: 0, 0, 0, 10
Pantone: Cool gray 1 C

Black
#000000
RGB: 0, 0, 0
CMYK: 0, 0, 0, 100
Pantone: Black 6 C

SECONDARY

Cobalt
#313CFF
RGB: 49, 60, 255
CMYK: 100, 59, 0, 26
Pantone: 2728 C

Violet
#8A25C9
RGB: 138, 37, 201
CMYK: 28, 69, 0, 30
Pantone: 2084 C

Turquois
#48C0D9
RGB: 72, 192, 217
CMYK: 58, 7, 0, 10
Pantone: 2227 C

Tangerine
#FF9E00
RGB: 255, 158, 0
CMYK: 0, 38, 100, 0
Pantone: 137 C

Lime
#cff933
RGB: 207, 249, 51
CMYK: 29, 0, 100, 0
Pantone: 2297 C

VECTOR INSTITUTE

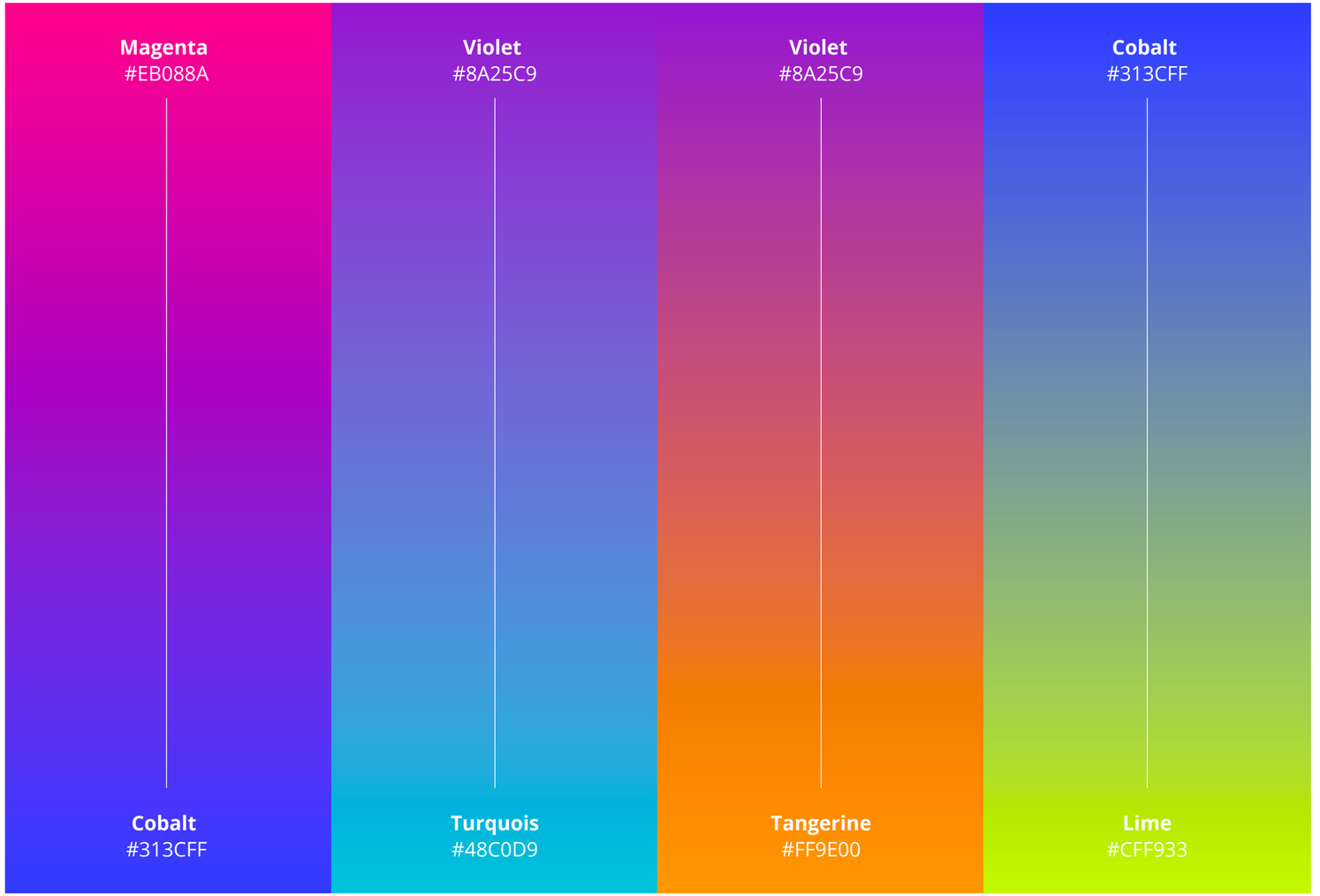
Colour

https://us05web.zoom.us/j/89542392666?pwd=GAzlPx6pMEzyqDBtsCi9fbuzChFqNx.1

Gradient usage

Our gradients are used as a background alternative colour where a solid colour does not provide enough visual interest. The primary gradient combination is magenta and cobalt. Secondary combinations are shown here. Secondary gradients are only to be used for topic specific scenarios outside of our primary branding and should not be applied to other elements including type and/or numbers.

Gradients can be used vertically or horizontally. Keep it consistent through the document whereas if its used vertically, do not use it horizontally on another page.



VECTOR INSTITUTE

Typography

The font or typeface we use gives readers a sense of our style and personality. We've chosen two similar fonts, depending on the use case.

Professional usage: Karbon is a clean, contemporary and versatile font. Used for external marketing materials, website, business cards, etc.

Download all font packs here

Karbon typeface



Karbon Semi Bold

ABCĆDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSŠTUVWX

YZŽabcćdefghijklmnopqrsštuvwxyz

ž1234567890‘?’“!”(%)[#]{@}/&\<-+÷×

=>®©$€£¥¢:;,.*

Karbon Regular

ABCĆDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSŠTUVWXY

ZŽabcćdefghijklmnopqrsštuvwxyzž123

4567890‘?’“!”(%)[#]{@}/&\<-+÷×=>®©$

€£¥¢:;,.*

VECTOR INSTITUTE

Typography Alternative

Our alternative font is Open Sans.

Used for body copy on website, internal purposes, as well as PPT presentations.

Download all font packs here

Open Sans typeface



Open Sans Semi Bold

ABCĆDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSŠT
UVWXYZŽabcćdefghijklmnop
qrsštuvwxyzž1234567890‘?’“!
”(%)[#]{@}/&\<-+÷×=>®©$€£¥
¢:;,.*

Open Sans Regular

ABCĆDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSŠTUV
WXYZŽabcćdefghijklmnopqrsštu
vwxyzž1234567890‘?’“!”(%)[#]{@
}/&\<-+÷×=>®©$€£¥¢:;,.*

VECTOR INSTITUTE

Typography Heirarchy

When Karbon is not available, use Open Sans semibold for headings.

HEADING
Karbon medium

Lorem ipsum dolor

SUBHEAD
Open Sans Bold

Consectetuer adipiscing sed diam nonummy nibh

BODY
Open Sans Regular

Euismod tincidunt ut laoreet dolore magna aliquam erat volutpat. Ut wisi enim ad minim veniam, quis nostrud exerci tation ullamcorper suscipit lobortis nisl ut aliquip ex ea commodo consequat. Duis autem vel eum iriure dolor in hendrerit in vulputate velit esse molestie consequat, vel illum dolore eu feugiat nulla facilisis at vero eros et accumsan et iusto odio dignissim qui blandit praesent luptatum zzril delenit augue duis dolore te feugait nulla facilisi Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, cons ectetuer adipiscing elit, is at vero eros et accumsan et iusto odio dignissim qui blandit praesent luptatum zzril

VECTOR INSTITUTE

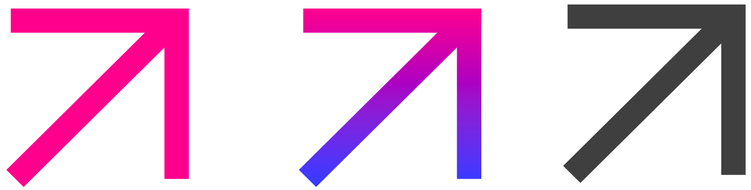
Illustrative Shapes

Branded shape usage

Our branded shapes help connect abstract concepts that our organization represents to the people who inspire and engage with us. This is most effective for stock images and our owned photography collection. Our collection of shapes can be used with the following treatments: Solid fill, gradient, gradient with photo, and photo fill. The branded shapes showcase a directional 'advancement' – similar to how Vector helps students, companies, businesses and partners advance with us.

The gradient shown here is the only approved gradient to use in these branded shapes.

Fastlane Arrow



Vector Arrow



Vector Arrow (Extended for split image treatments)



Medical Cross (Healthcare specific usage)



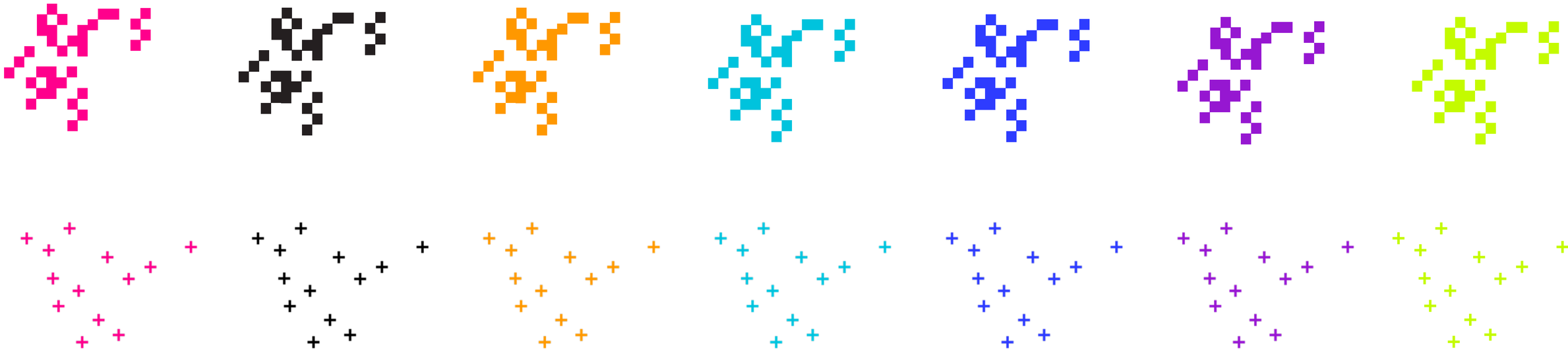
VECTOR INSTITUTE

Illustrative Patterns

Branded pattern usage

Our graphical patterns are used to add versatility, layer, and visual interest to accompany visual content. The visual notes ellude to the idea that a pixilated or nodule element are coming into focus and directionally ‘advance’ – similar to how Vector helps students, companies, businesses and partners advance with us.

Branded patterns can be cut off in application and rotated at 90 degree increments only.



VECTOR INSTITUTE

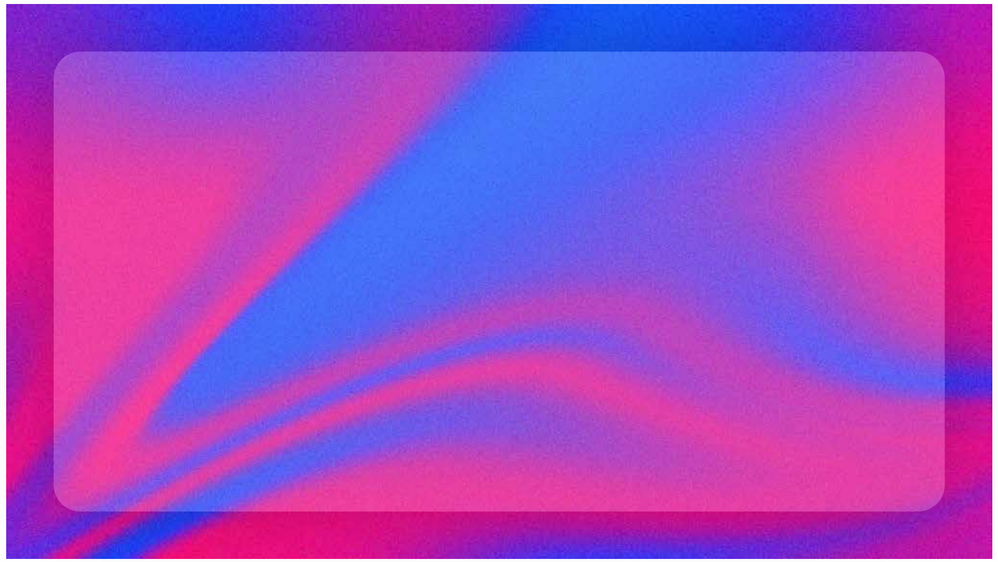
Backgrounds

Background usage

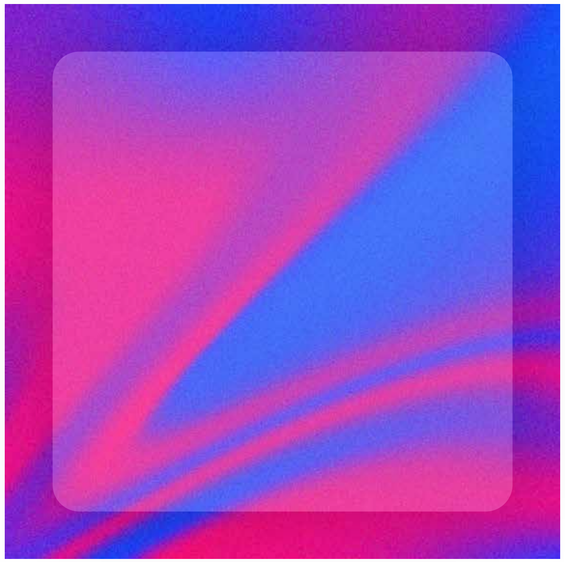
Abstract gradient backgrounds provide brand recognition and visual interest across all collateral.
For text-only applications, pair gradients with a semi-transparent overlay box using the following specifications.
Gradients can also be combined with split-screen photo treatments.

Corner radius: 0.25"
Fill: White at 20% opacity
Coverage: 85-90% of frame

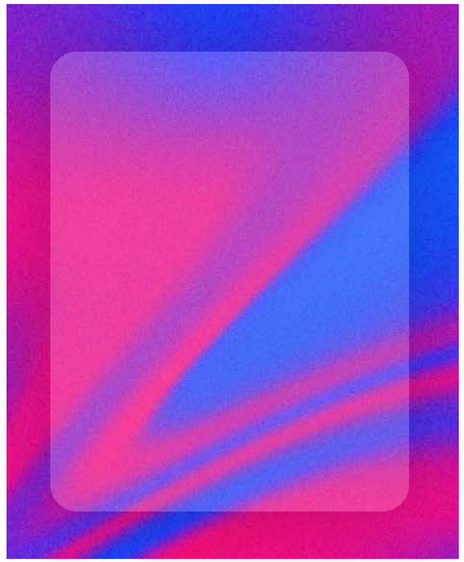
16x9



1x1



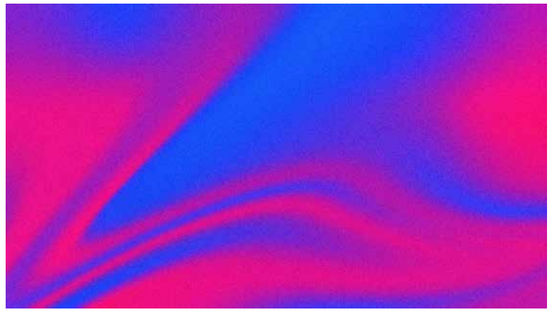
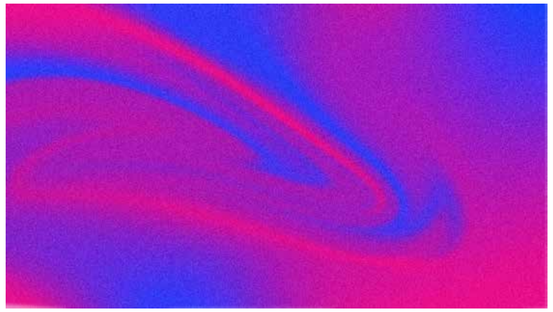
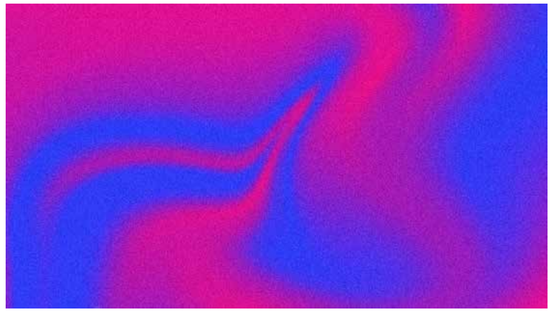
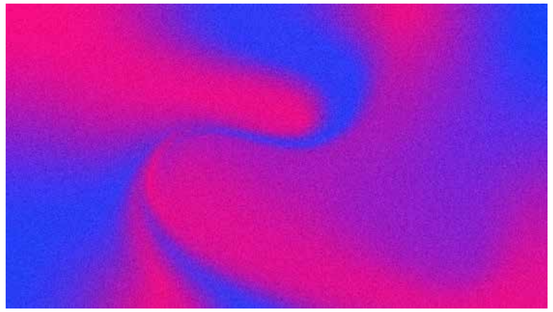
4x5



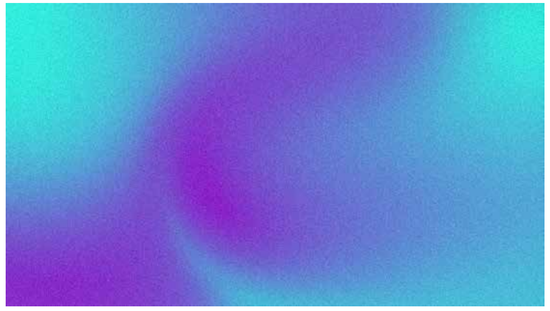
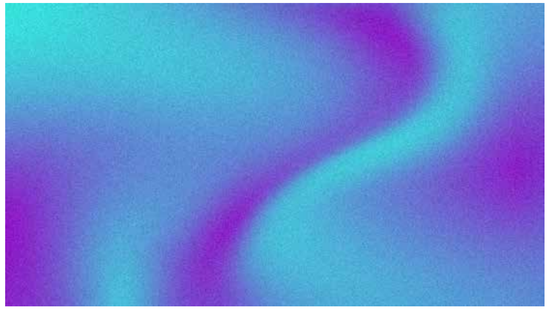
VECTOR INSTITUTE

Graphic Backgrounds

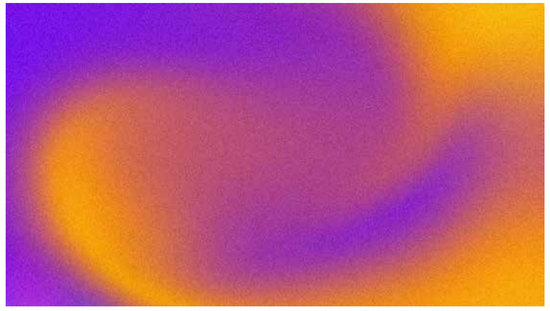
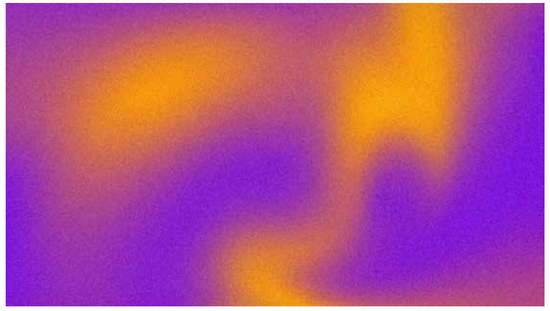
Magenta & Cobalt

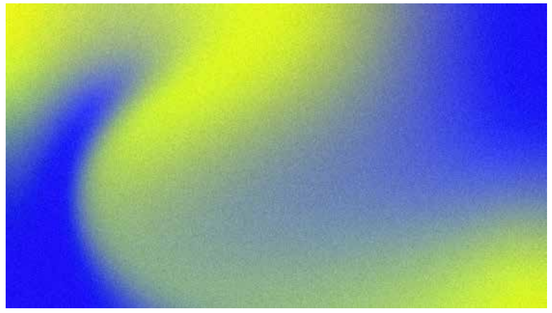
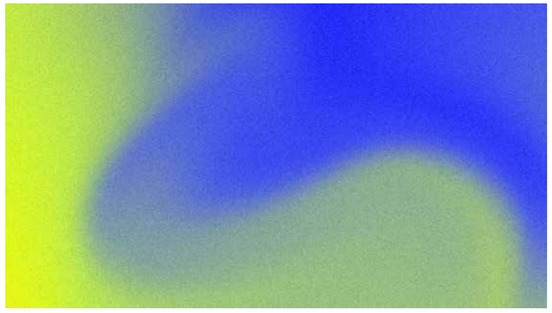
Violet & Turquoise

Violet & Tangerine

Cobalt & Lime

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Photography

Brand photo library

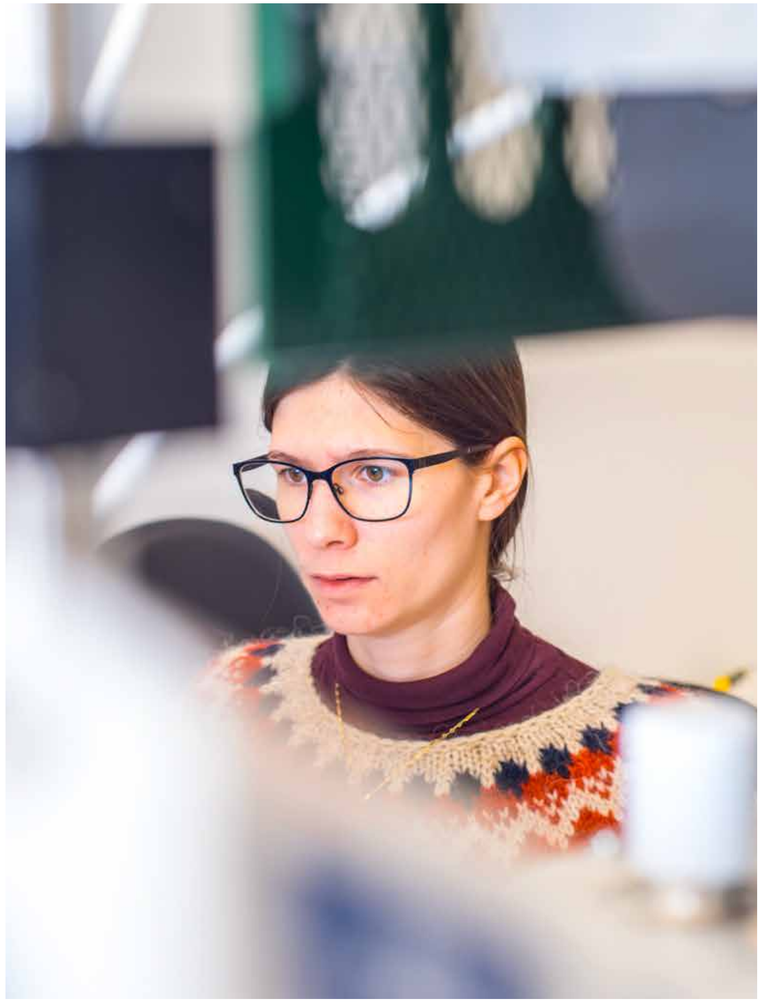
Our stakeholders build an emotional connection with the images we use whether they be stock / licensed or taken at an event. Images are an important connection between Vector's brand, our purpose and our stakeholders. Vector's photography library has been selected to convey our core brand personality traits: contemporary, leading edge, Innovative/creative, smart/bright/ confident, and remarkable. Our stock photography library provides contextual visual relevance to our user personas (both internal and external market personas), their expertise, such as the technology or the workplace setting, they are commonly found in.

Access our photo library here.









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Photography









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Photography









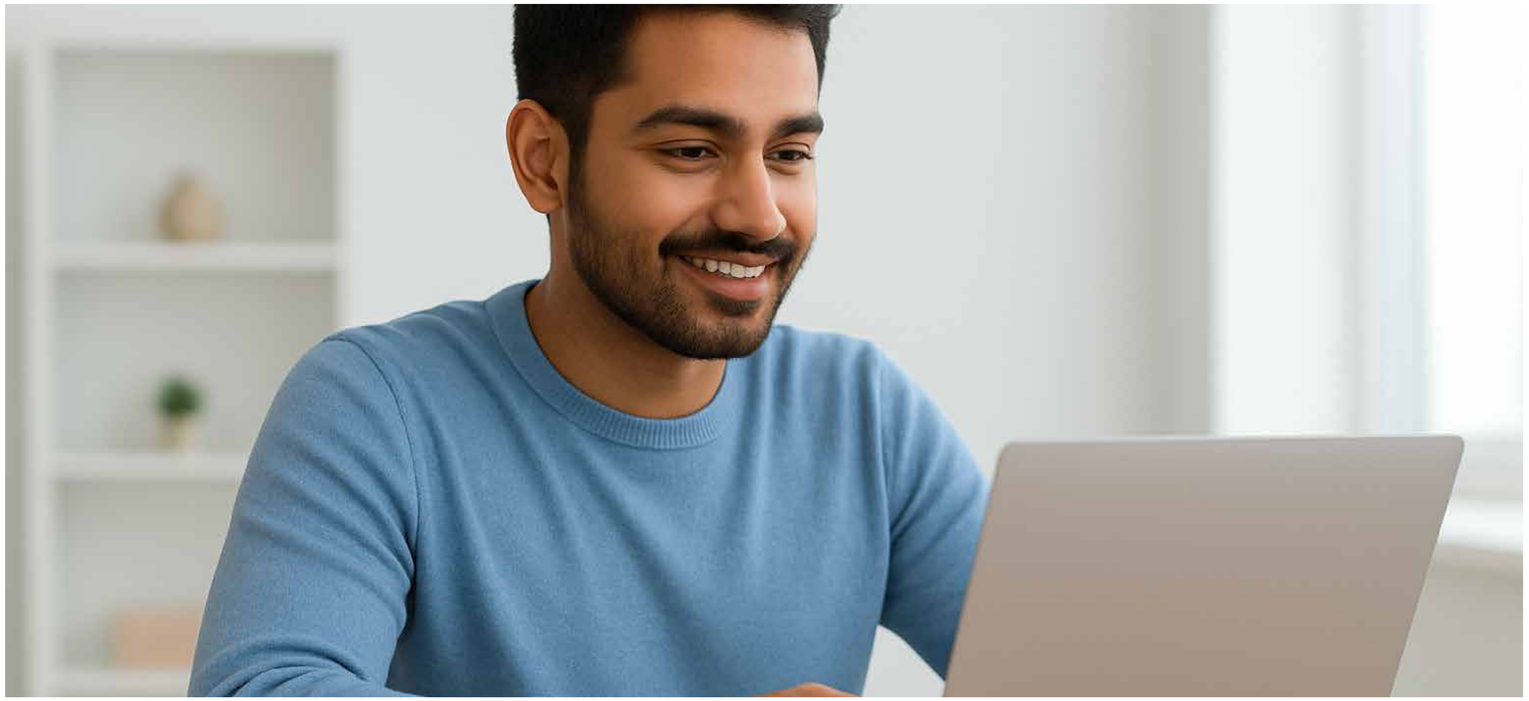
VECTOR INSTITUTE

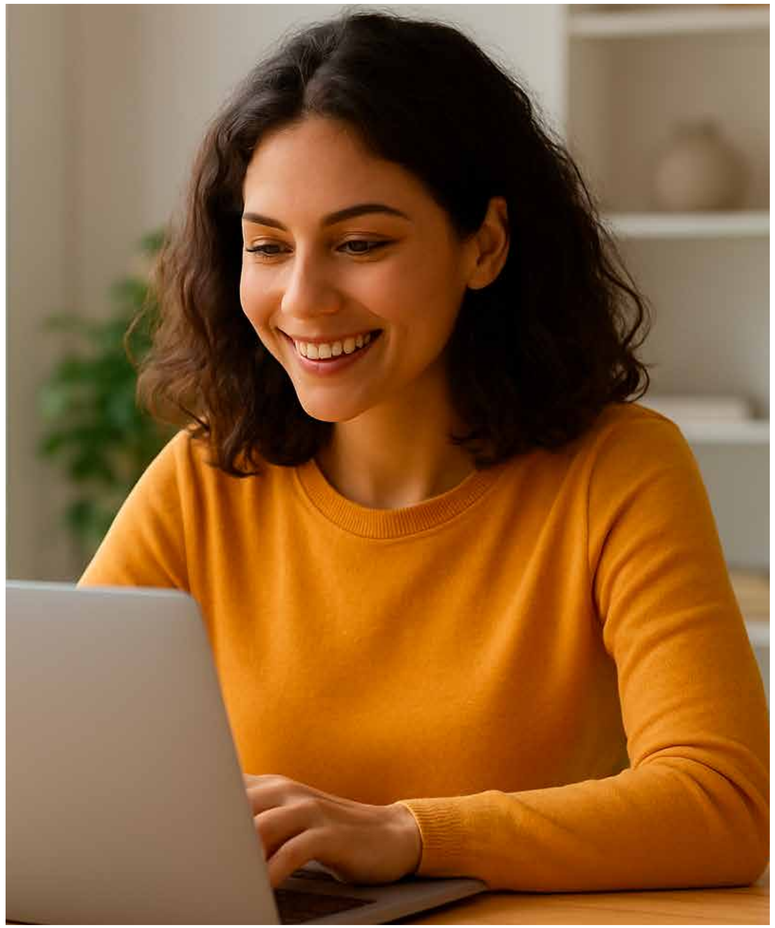
Photography

Generated image usage

We keep all AI imagery aligned with our established visual style, ensuring colour, composition, and tone remain consistent. Avoid outputs that feel misleading, low quality, or visually inconsistent. Accuracy, ethics, and cultural sensitivity, are top of mind at all times and we will disclose when an image could be mistaken for reality.

Disclaimer: **AI generated images must be approved by Marketing.**





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Visual Rules

Image containers

Apply rounded corners to all placed images. Do not apply rounded corners to full-bleed images.







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Visual Rules

Portrait images

Portrait images (for bios) should be cropped into a circular format. An optional keyline may be applied using an approved gradient or a solid colour from the brand palette. When a portrait has a white or very light background, a keyline in black or a brand colour should be used to clearly define the shape..







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Visual Rules

Visual rules

DO:
Keep design cohesive and on-brand, stick to MAXIMUM 2 colours in your layout. Designs are also limited to 1-2 design elements per asset.



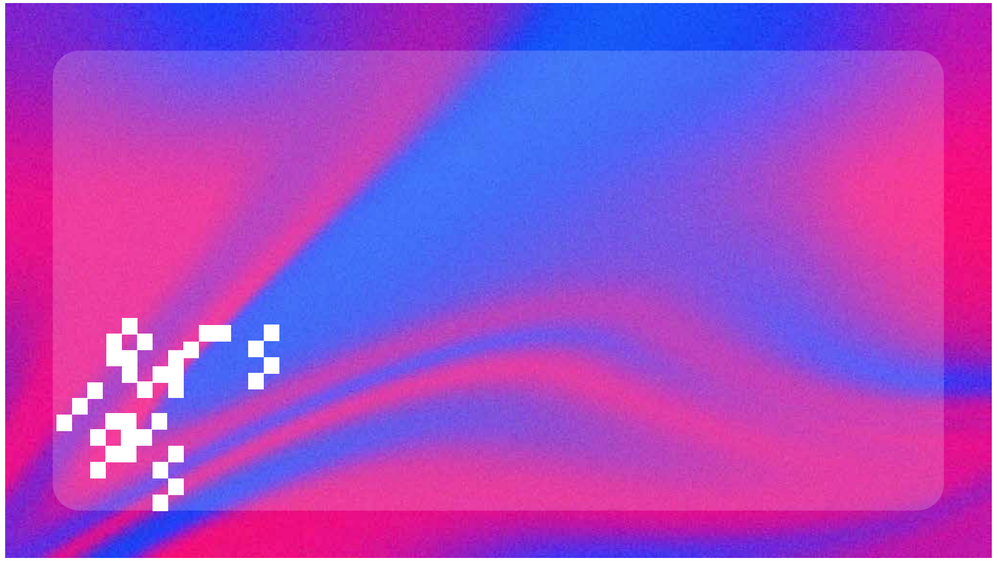
DO NOT:
Overly clutter layouts. All assets should stay within brand guidelines (ex. using Vector fonts &colours). Avoid using too many colours in one place or using photography that does not align with our brand. Avoid using gradients on arrows in conjunction with other colours. Gradient arrows should only be used on a white background & image as a separator.



Visual Rules

Visual rules

DO:
Branded patterns are ok to use over top of this treatment.



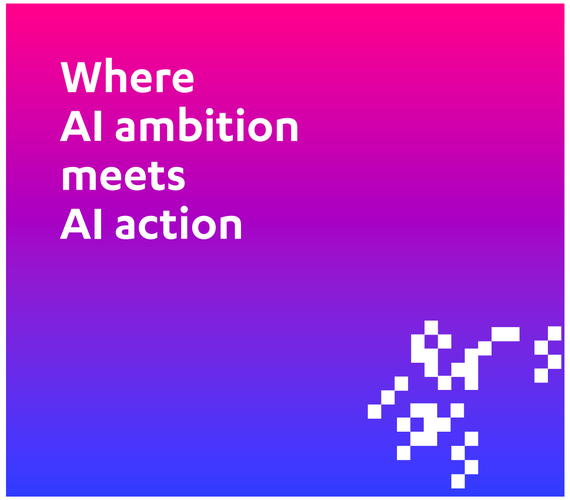
DO NOT:
Avoid placing images over top of the graphic patterns.



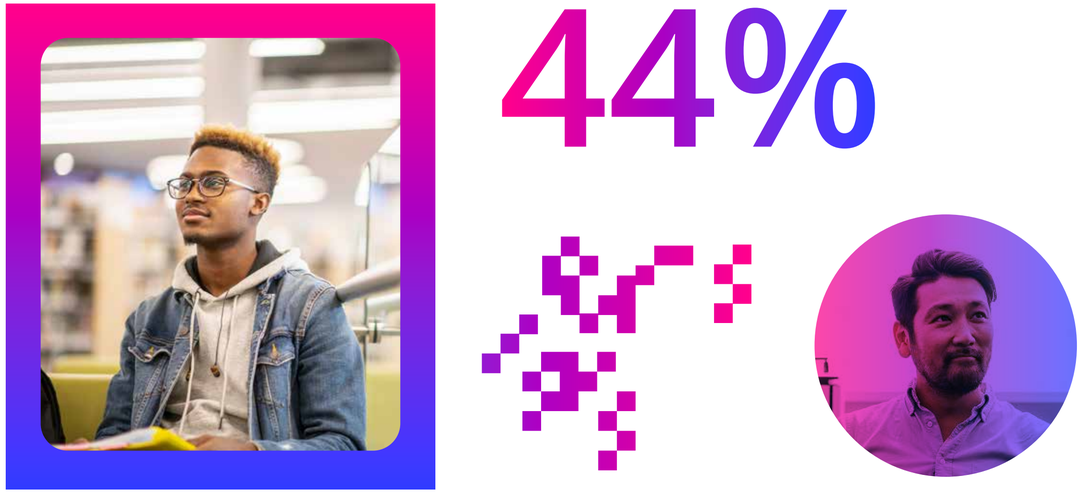
VECTOR INSTITUTE

Visual rules

DO:
Gradients should be used primarily as backgrounds for large headlines—not body copy—to maintain readability. When paired with graphic patterns, use the pattern in white or a legible colour from the brand palette that matches one of the colours within the gradient. See the use-case examples in this document for reference.



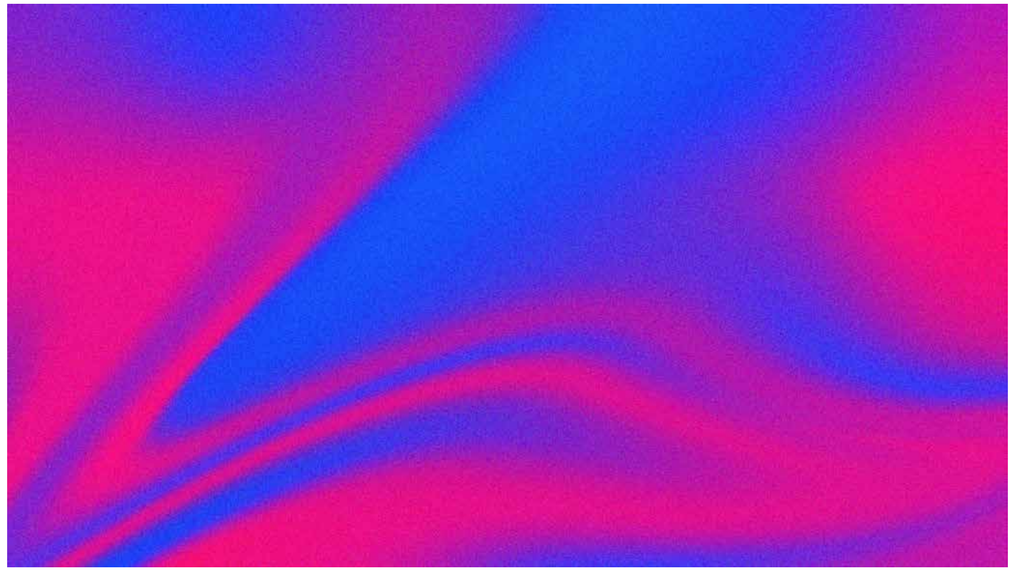
DO NOT:
Gradients should not be placed over imagery or photographic backgrounds, as this can interfere with clarity and visual hierarchy. They should also not be used within graphic patterns or as fills for numbers. Gradients are reserved for specific, approved applications and should not be introduced as decorative elements beyond those contexts.



Visual Rules

Graphic vs. gradient backgrounds

These images are referred to as **graphic backgrounds**. When using them, select the gradient background (shown to the right) in the corresponding colour. Keeping graphic backgrounds and gradients in the same colour variation ensures visual consistency across your document.



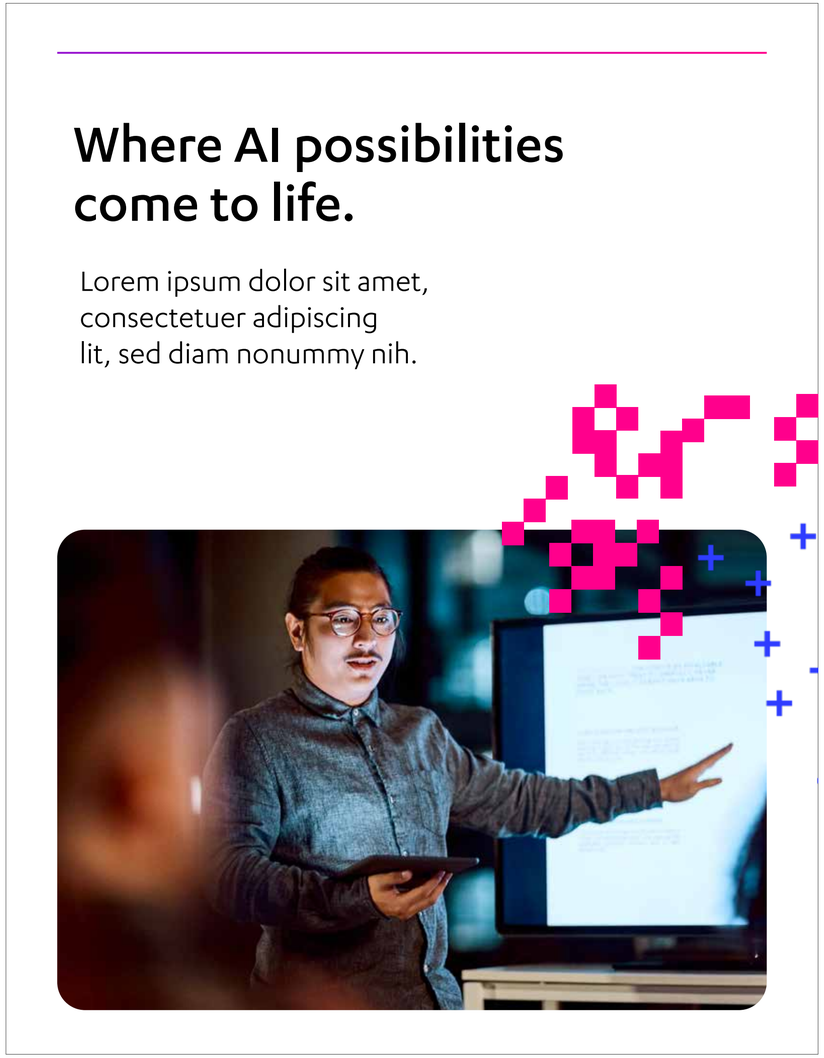
These images are referred to as **gradient backgrounds**. Gradient backgrounds are available in multiple colour variations. When using them, pair the gradient background with the corresponding graphic background (shown to the left) in the same colour. This helps maintain a consistent and cohesive look throughout your document.



Brand Application

Bringing it all together

This example shows how the core brand elements work in combination. Graphic shapes can be used to overlay imagery, while layouts should use only two to three colours from the brand palette at a time to maintain a clean, cohesive look. Generous white space allows the graphics and bold colours to stand out, and gradients can be applied subtly on divider lines to add visual interest while maintaining clarity.

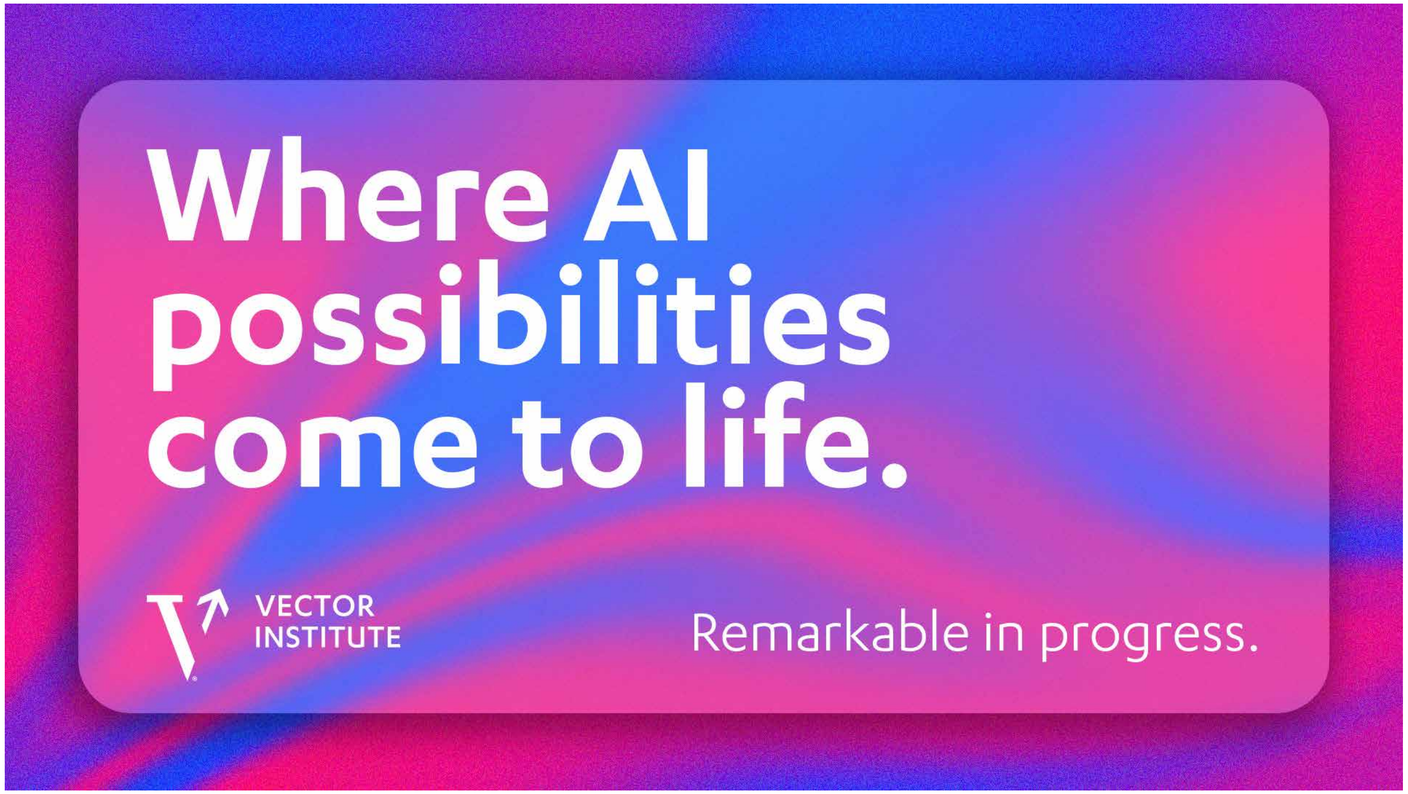


VECTOR INSTITUTE

Brand Application

Bringing it all together

Whenever possible, we want to leverage our gradient background with this rounded box overlay treatment. This works best for text-only images.



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Brand Application

Bringing it all together

When introducing other elements, it is important to ensure there is harmony with all pieces. This is an example of an image that depicts many elements working together. The upward arrow acts as a split-screen divider between two images. The plus-sign pattern is included to promote brand recognition. All text, images, and brand elements lay on our gradient background which acts as a brand identifier.



VECTOR INSTITUTE

Brand Application

Bringing it all together

When introducing other elements, it is important to ensure there is harmony with all pieces. This is an example of an image that depicts many elements working together. The upward arrow acts as a frame to a single image. The plus-sign pattern is included to promote brand recognition. All text, images, and brand elements lay on our gradient background which acts as a brand identifier.



VECTOR INSTITUTE

Brand Application

Bringing it all together

In application the secondary colours can be used for accents and highlights to identify a specific segment: Broader Public Sector **#313CFF**, Industry **#8A25C9**, and Academic Institutions **#48C0D9** when accompanying the primary colours.

Industry



Broader Public Sector



Academic Institutions



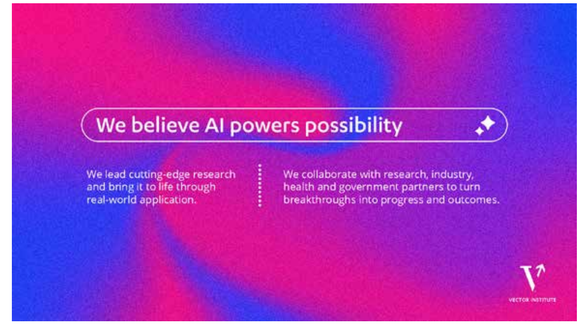
VECTOR INSTITUTE

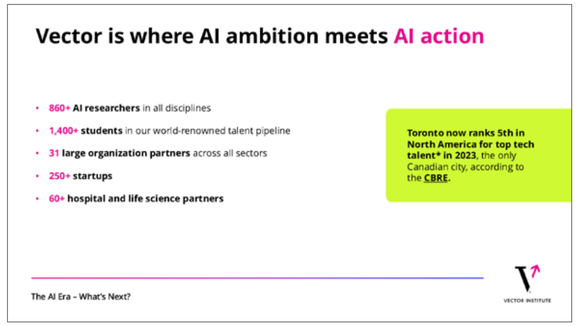
Brand Application

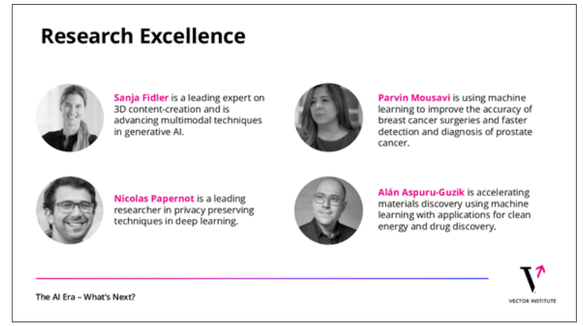
PowerPoint templates

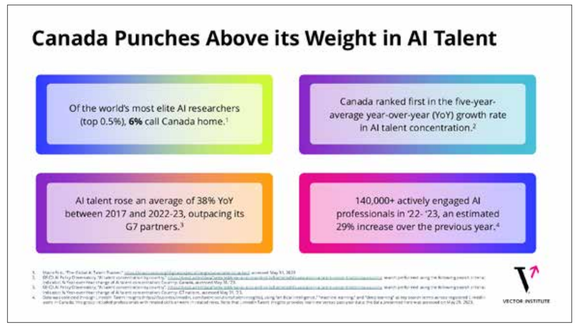
Examples provided for visual references only.

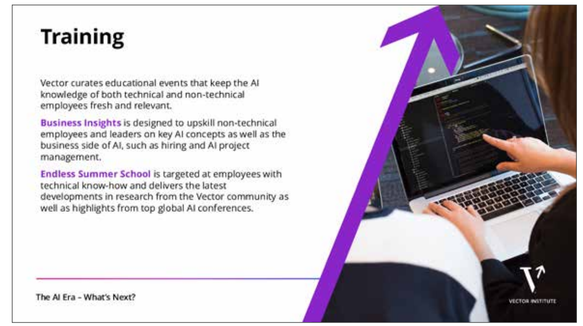












VECTOR INSTITUTE

Equity, diversity and inclusion Values

Email Signature

NAME
Open Sans Semibold, Magenta

TITLE
Open Sans Semibold, Black

BODY
Open Sans Regular

SIGN OFF
Open Sans Regular Italic,
1 pt size smaller

Formal Signature

First Name Last Name (Pronouns), credentials
Title

t: 000.000.0000 m: 000.000.0000
e: (name)@vectorinstitute.ai

Vector Institute
Schwartz Reisman Innovation Campus
W1140-108 College Street,
Toronto, ON M5G 0C6

In the spirit of reconciliation, the Vector Institute respectfully acknowledges that for thousands of years, the land on which Vector operates has been the traditional lands of many nations including the Mississaugas of the Credit, the Anishnabeg, the Chippewa, the Haudenosaunee, and the Wendat peoples.

My working day may not be your working day. Please do not feel obliged to reply to this email outside of your normal working hours.

Simplified Signature

First Name Last Name (Pronouns), credentials
Title
Vector Institute
000.000.0000

In the spirit of reconciliation, the Vector Institute respectfully acknowledges that for thousands of years, the land on which Vector operates has been the traditional lands of many nations including the Mississaugas of the Credit, the Anishnabeg, the Chippewa, the Haudenosaunee, and the Wendat peoples.

My working day may not be your working day. Please do not feel obliged to reply to this email outside of your normal working hours.

VECTOR INSTITUTE

Equity, diversity and inclusion Values

The addition of equity, diversity and inclusion (EDI) values to Vector’s brand guide is to ensure the brand is equitable and inclusive. Using the right language, photography and images shows that our community respects everyone that engages with our brand. That said, because language and imagery can be imprecise and our collective understanding of inclusivity changes over time, this will be a living document rather than the final word on inclusive brand guidelines.

Photography and images

When using images and videos from Vector Institute image libraries or capturing at events, it's crucial to do so in a manner that's respectful of all individuals represented, with special care taken for those from historically marginalized communities. To avoid reinforcing harmful stereotypes or biases, select visuals that match the context of the content and align with the subject matter. Prior consent from people in the images is necessary for use in Vector communications, ensuring images relate to the individuals' actual contribution or the subject at hand. Unrelated use of Indigenous symbols and motifs should be avoided, and appropriate permissions should be obtained for artwork not in the public domain.

Events and photos of our community

Consent is required for using personal images for Vector’s communications, highlighting the significance of respecting privacy at events. Even if signage is displayed indicating photos and videos will be taken at an event, and written consent cannot be obtained post-event, the images and videos should not be reproduced. Vector Institute’s photography library houses only those photos of people who have given their consent for Vector to use their image in a variety of Vector communications and marketing materials. This stresses the due diligence needed in verifying consent before using any imagery to uphold the integrity and responsibilities of the institution's communicators.

Infographics

For infographics, it is necessary to ensure that the information presented is accurate, relevant, and adequately represents data and narratives constructively. Infographics require comprehensive research, writing, and design expertise, making them complex projects that need careful planning and execution. They should provide clear data visualization that resonates with the audience, and is accessible to all users, adhering to Vector Institute's standard of excellence for our brand.

Use of representations of communities that have been historically misrepresented in photos or imagery at Vector

Vector Institute’s guidelines encourage respectful imagery usage, particularly regarding communities that have been historically misrepresented. This is why images should be relevant to the content, with consent from the individuals if applicable - unless stock photos are being used. Attribution is crucial when featuring any artwork from historically misrepresented or marginalized communities, ensuring due respect and correct representation. Avoid using stereotypical or harmful depictions, underscoring the Institute’s commitment to inclusivity and cultural sensitivity in all forms of communication.

Consent

Vector Institute is committed to using images in an ethical and respectful way, with extra care given to representations of communities that have historically been misrepresented. Vector’s photo library only includes images of individuals who have provided informed consent for their likeness to be featured in Vector Institute communications materials, and Vector always provides clear attribution for artwork, ensuring due respect and correct representation. Stock photos are exempted from the individual consent requirement. We avoid images that may reinforce stereotypes or depictions that could be harmful to the communities we depict and serve, underscoring the Institute’s commitment to inclusivity and cultural sensitivity in all forms of communication.

Equity, diversity and inclusion Values

EDI: Directional and advertorial signage

In alignment with Vector Institute's EDI commitments, all signage should reflect consistency, accuracy, and design standards set forth by Vector’s Brand Guide. Each sign must be pre-approved by the Vector Institute Marketing team, especially when deviating from standard materials or creating new signs. The categories cover a range of needs, from wayfinding to room identification, following clear typeface, colour, and mounting directives to ensure readability and accessibility for all users.

Equity, diversity and inclusion Values

Accessibility

Vector complies with the Accessibility for Ontarians with Disabilities Act (AODA). It's important that our information is accessible to people with disabilities. Here are some guidelines to help ensure compliance.

Layout

Ensure sufficient whitespace between columns of text to help people with low vision and users of screen reading software, as well as those with sensory or cognitive disabilities can easily read Vector's communications.

Font

Format documents with high contract. Black text on white provides the highest contrast.

Font size should be 11 point or larger in Word documents and 18 points or larger in PowerPoint.

Graphics

Images, graphics, or photos should include tag descriptions or alternative text, also known as alt tag, to ensure screen readers can read the explanation.

Avoid cluttering pages with many graphic images

Avoid flashing or blinking elements.

Do not layer text on top of graphics

PowerPoint

Keep your slides uncluttered using only four to six bullets or fewer per slide.

PDF

Create PDFs from the source document by clicking Convert to Adobe PDF in the programs menu bar to keep accessibility tags, such as headers and alternative text.

Fill in the document's page properties with a title, an author and assign the appropriate language.

Do not link to or attach a PDF document tht is scanned as a graphic image. Scanned documents are not accessible.

Use the Adobe Acrobat accessibility check to identify and correct any issues in meeting the accessibility standards.

Questions?



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Please email marcomm@vectorinstitute.ai